

KOLKATA

AIRBNB AND REAL ESTATE GUIDE

Airbnb data: Airbtics Nov 2024-Oct 2025. Tourism: India Tourism Data Compendium 2025 (Union Tourism Ministry). Real estate: 99acres May 2026. Metro: realtypromoo, 99acres.

West Bengal was India's second highest state for foreign tourist arrivals in 2024, behind only Maharashtra. Kolkata achieves this despite minimal direct international flight connectivity, which suggests its true foreign footfall is understated. Airbnb in Kolkata is a high-demand, low-price market: strong occupancy, modest nightly rates. With the Orange Line metro targeted for December 2026 and property prices still the lowest of any major metro, the early-mover window is real. This guide covers the Airbnb market, tourism context, and real estate with verified data.

TOURISM DATA

Source: India Tourism Data Compendium 2025

West Bengal Foreign Tourist Arrivals

Metric	Figure	Source
Foreign tourist arrivals 2024	31 lakh (3.12 million)	India Tourism Data Compendium 2025
Foreign tourist arrivals 2023	27 lakh	India Tourism Data Compendium 2025
Year-on-year growth	+14.8%	Calculated from above
National rank (foreign arrivals)	2nd in India	Behind Maharashtra; ahead of UP, Gujarat, Rajasthan
Share of India total FTAs	14.92%	India Tourism Data Compendium 2025
Daily international arrivals (Kolkata)	51 per day	vs Mumbai 516, Delhi 590 -- likely undercounted

The undercounting point matters for an investor. Kolkata has almost no direct flights to Europe or the US, so many foreign tourists arrive via Mumbai or Delhi and get counted under those states. Despite that, West Bengal still ranks 2nd nationally. The drivers are durable and cultural: Durga Puja (now UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage), Tagore's legacy, colonial architecture, the Sundarbans, and Darjeeling. This is demand built on heritage, not hype.

KOLKATA AIRBNB MARKET

Source: Airbtics, Nov 2024 to Oct 2025

Core Market Metrics

Metric	Data	Notes	Source
Median occupancy	45%	Top 30% in India for occupancy	Airbtics
Average daily rate	Rs 2,336/night	Lowest 15% in India for ADR	Airbtics
Annual revenue (median)	Rs 3.89 lakh	All listing types combined	Airbtics
Active listings	1,378	Mature, competitive market	Airbtics

Nights booked per year	164 nights	High by Tier 1 standards	Airbtics
Peak / weakest month	Dec / July	Durga Puja (Oct) and winter season drive demand	Airbtics

ADR and Occupancy Distribution

Performer Tier	Occupancy	ADR/Night	Estimated Annual Revenue
Bottom 25% (entry)	~28-32%	Rs 1,500-1,800	~Rs 1.7-2.1 lakh
Median (50th percentile)	45%	Rs 2,336	Rs 3.89 lakh
Top quartile (75th pctile)	~58-62%	Rs 3,200-3,800	~Rs 6-7 lakh
Top 10% (best-in-class)	~70%+	Rs 4,500+	~Rs 10-12 lakh

The Kolkata thesis in one line: this is a volume market, not a rate market. At 45% median occupancy Kolkata sits in the top 30% of India for how often listings are booked, but ADR is in the lowest 15% nationally. You make money here by keeping the property booked, not by charging premium nightly rates. The operator who wins is the one who optimises for occupancy -- competitive pricing, fast responses, strong reviews -- rather than holding out for high nightly rates. Top quartile properties near heritage zones and business districts meaningfully outperform the median.

REAL ESTATE MARKET

Source: 99acres May 2026

Price by Locality -- Verified from 99acres

Locality	Flat Price/Sqft	3-Year Appreciation	Best For
Salt Lake	Rs 8,650-15,650 Avg Rs 10,750	+35.2%	Premium, established, IT proximity (Sector V)
New Town / Rajarhat	Rs 6,200-11,200 Avg Rs 7,800	+24.8% (+9.9% 1yr)	Growth corridor, metro-linked, IT demand
Premium localities*	Start Rs 5,500	Varies	New Town, Salt Lake, Noapara, Uniworld City
Affordable East Kolkata	Up to Rs 4,500	Varies	Hatiara, Krishnapur, Bishnupur -- entry budget

Rental yields in Kolkata average ~4%, but select pockets perform far better -- Garfa (8.0%), Sector 4 Salt Lake (7.6%) per 99acres. Kolkata remains the most affordable major metro in India on a per-sqft basis, which is central to the early-mover argument.

The Metro Catalyst

Project	Route	Timeline	Impact
Orange Line (New Garia-Airport)	29 km via EM Bypass, New Town, Salt Lake Sector V	Targeted Dec 2026	Connects southern suburbs to airport. Cuts journey to ~56 min. Direct uplift to New Town and Salt Lake.
Yellow Line (Airport phase)	Noapara to Jai Hind (airport)	Opened Aug 2025	First-ever metro link to airport terminal.

Purple Line (Joka-Esplanade)	Joka-Majerhat operational	Full by 2028	Joka emerging as early-investor corridor.
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Note on Salt Lake 1-year figures: some 99acres listed data shows sharp swings driven by shifts in the sample mix toward luxury projects. Actual transacted price changes are more moderate. Always verify current pricing and circle rates directly. West Bengal revised circle rates upward (15-90%) effective September 17, 2025, which affects stamp duty.

SHORT-TERM RENTAL SETUP

Rental arbitrage for Kolkata

Sample Budget -- Kolkata 2BHK from Unfurnished (Salt Lake / New Town)

Item	Amount	Notes
Monthly rent (2BHK unfurnished)	Rs 14,000-20,000	Salt Lake / New Town, 99acres verified
Security deposit (2-3 months)	Rs 28,000-50,000	
Beds x2 + mattresses	Rs 32,000	Guest quality
Bed frames + sofa + dining	Rs 33,000	
Wardrobes + curtains	Rs 15,000	
Split AC 1.5 ton	Rs 32,000	Essential. Kolkata summers and humidity.
TV 32 inch	Rs 12,000	
Geyser + fans	Rs 10,000	
Kitchen setup + linen	Rs 15,000	
Decor + heritage theme	Rs 10,000	Colonial / Bengali aesthetic resonates with guests
Professional photography	Rs 8,000	Non-negotiable.
WiFi + miscellaneous	Rs 6,500	
TOTAL SETUP	Rs 2.18-2.43 lakh	Higher rent than Tier 2 cities but still under Rs 2.5L.

Five Things to Do Before You Sign Any Lease

- Optimise for occupancy, not nightly rate. Kolkata is a volume market. Competitive pricing and fast guest response will beat holding out for premium rates. Your goal is to stay above the 45% median occupancy, not above the median ADR.
- Position near Salt Lake Sector V or New Town for business and IT demand, or near Park Street and heritage zones for tourist demand. These two guest profiles want very different locations -- pick one and design for it.
- Price hard for Durga Puja (Oct) and the Nov-Dec winter season. This is your peak window when the city floods with domestic and international visitors. Dynamic pricing in these weeks can carry a large share of annual revenue.
- Factor in the Orange Line metro timing. If you can secure a property within 1 km of a New Town or Salt Lake Sector V station before December 2026, you capture both the connectivity uplift and the price re-rating that typically follows metro commissioning.
- Confirm the landlord allows short-term rental and subletting in writing, and check the society or complex rules separately. This applies in Kolkata exactly as in any other Indian city.

